Casey Caster

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Strategy and operations executive and current CTO chief of staff with 15+ years connecting technology strategy to disciplined execution in payments, financial services, and cloud infrastructure. At SingleStore, partners with the CTO on cost optimization, M&A, governance, and AI platform operations, and rescued a failing partner integration to unlock $30M+ in recurring ARR. At Ripple, built the implementation function and the bank C-suite governance committee for the RippleNet payments network; at Wells Fargo, delivered a $20M+ digital transformation. Executive MBA (Cornell and Queen's); PMP.

Core Competencies

- **Technology Strategy to Execution (CTO Office)**: Chief of staff to the CPO and then the CTO; strategic planning and executive decision support that turn technology priorities into roadmaps, owned programs, and measurable outcomes.
- **Portfolio Planning & Investment Decisions**: Manages the engineering budget with Finance; built a COGS intelligence engine tying growth trends to investment decisions; Autodesk portfolio optimization across 150+ projects.
- **Governance & Operating Mechanisms**: Created the RippleNet Committee and network business rules with bank C-suite executives; built SingleStore's GenAI governance program; runs capacity planning and delivery dashboards.
- **Financial Services, Fintech & Payments**: Scaled delivery for Ripple's bank payments network from its first 12 banks to 200+ members; $20M+ digital transformation at Wells Fargo.
- **Organizational Design & Change Management**: Built Ripple's global delivery organization from 4 project managers; 5x engineering velocity through agile transformation; integrated acquired teams after M&A.
- **Technical Fluency: AI, Cloud & Platform Modernization**: Internal development platform (70% fewer bottlenecks); 50% lower cloud spend; AI enablement with Claude Code, Amazon Bedrock, and Google Vertex AI.

Professional Experience

- **SingleStore** **San Francisco, CA**
  Sr Director, Engineering - Internal Services & Technical Program Management (CTO Chief of Staff) *2021-Present*
  Strategy and operations for a cloud-native database company in hypergrowth, reporting to the CPO and then the CTO in a chief-of-staff role. Leads seven teams through a director, two managers, a TPM who runs quality assurance, and two principal architects (32 people).
  - **Unlocked $30M+ in recurring ARR** by stepping in to rescue a failing strategic partner integration and leading a cross-functional realignment through to delivery.
  - **Manages the engineering budget with Finance** and runs engineering capacity planning and delivery dashboards; built a COGS intelligence engine that connects growth trends to investment decisions.
  - **Increased engineering velocity 5x** through agile transformation and accountability systems.
  - **Cut internal cloud spend by 50%** through cross-team policy reform and usage modeling; launched an internal development platform that reduced infrastructure bottlenecks by 70%.
  - **Drove internal GenAI adoption** through a governance and ops program and new internal platforms; leads AI tooling across the development stack, including Claude Code.
  - **De-risked M&A** by leading technical due diligence and analyzing mergers, then integrating acquired teams; negotiates vendor contracts, including LLM token pricing.

- **Ripple, Inc.** **San Francisco, CA**
  Global Head of Program Management, Customer Success *2016-2020*
  Promoted to lead global delivery programs for RippleNet, Ripple's blockchain payments network for banks, and to architect its implementation function.
  - **Established the RippleNet Committee**, a global governance body, negotiating with C-suite executives of major banks; the network grew to hundreds of members handling millions of transactions.
  - **Cut customer delivery time 75%**, from eight months to eight weeks, across 800+ global implementations.
  - **Built the organization from 4 project managers** to three managers of project management, 25 project managers, and 75+ engineers and architects indirectly across four regions.
  - **Oversaw a joint venture in Japan** from formation to a strong market position, delivering implementations at 68+ additional Japanese banks.
  - **Negotiated and fulfilled SOWs and MSAs** with enterprise financial institutions as part of customer care and global infrastructure strategy.
- **Wells Fargo Bank** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager *2014-2015*
  - **Led cross-functional programs** to improve banking operations, customer experience, and organizational efficiency.
  - **Delivered a $20M+ digital transformation initiative**, coordinating 300+ testers.
  - **Led an upgrade of project portfolio systems** for 10,000+ vendors.
- **Autodesk** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Program Manager, Head of Continuous Improvement *2013-2014*
  - **Led portfolio optimization with $2M+ in savings** and improved user satisfaction.
- **Engajer** **Mountain View, CA**
  Head of Customer Success *2012-2013*
  - Built programs supporting 850+ customers; increased revenue 20% per account with 85% retention.
- **Avanade** **San Francisco, CA**
  Senior Consultant *2010-2012*
  - Delivered CRM and communications transformations in utilities and healthcare.

Selected Accomplishments

- **Implemented a $4M virtual testing network program** with teams in Bangalore and London, saving hundreds of person-hours per test cycle.
- **Mentored dozens of team members**, three of whom became CEOs at other companies.

Education & Certifications

- **Executive MBA**, Cornell University (Johnson) and Queen's University (Smith), dual degree
- **BS, Electronic Engineering Technology**, DeVry University, Pomona, CA
- **Project Management Professional (PMP)**, Project Management Institute

References

- Available upon request.